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The HP Pavilion Plus 16's display does show notable strengths and a few weaknesses in comparison to other 16-inch laptops. Its peak brightness of 403 cd/m² is competitive, offering good visibility in various lighting conditions, though it falls short of the MacBook Pro 16-inch's 1000 nits sustained and 1600 nits peak brightness, and is comparable to the 400 nits of the HP Pavilion Plus 16.

In terms of colour accuracy and range, the Pavilion Plus 16's impressive 99.4% sRGB and 81.6% DCI-P3 coverage are strong, but not quite at the level of the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360's 120% DCI-P3 colour volume. However, the Pavilion's average Delta E of 3.9, indicating minor colour inaccuracies, is higher than the ideal and suggests it lags slightly behind the top models like the MacBook Pro 16-inch and the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360 in colour precision.

Compared to the MacBook Pro 16-inch, known for its exceptional speaker quality and immersive audio experience, this laptop's speakers fall short. Similarly, against the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360, which features superior AKG-tuned speakers, this laptop lacks in audio richness and depth. For high-quality audio, the MacBook Pro 16-inch and Galaxy Book3 Pro 360 are better options.

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PERFORMANCE

The Dell XPS 17, Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra, and HP Pavilion Plus 16 show varied performance in Cinebench benchmarks, reflecting their different market positions. The Dell XPS 17 consistently leads in both single and multi-core tasks (Cinebench R15 CPU: 2611, R20 n-Thread: 6680, R23 n-Thread: 17113), marking it as a high-end, performance-focused laptop. The Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra, while slightly behind the Dell, still delivers robust performance, especially in multi-core scenarios (R15 CPU: 2348, R20 n-Thread: 5857, R23 n-Thread: 15319), balancing between power and cost.

In contrast, the HP Pavilion Plus 16, more budget-friendly, performs respectably, especially in OpenGL (R15: 221.89) but falls behind in CPU benchmarks (R15 CPU: 2234, R20 n-Thread: 4918, R23 n-Thread: 11238). This positions it as a value-for-money option for less demanding users. The Dell XPS 17 and Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra, with their superior CPU performance, cater to a higher-end market, offering more power for demanding applications.

In my analysis, I found that the Dell XPS 17 and the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra exhibit superior SSD performance compared to the HP Pavilion Plus 16. The top variants of the Dell and Samsung laptops showcase impressive read and write speeds, with the Dell XPS 17 achieving 6783.4 MB/s and 5613.91 MB/s, and the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra at 6690.97 MB/s and 4955.05 MB/s, respectively. This high level of performance aligns with their positioning in the market as premium, more expensive models.

In contrast, the HP Pavilion Plus 16, which I found to be significantly more affordable, offers slightly lower SSD speeds at 6205.09 MB/s read and 5316.91 MB/s write. Despite not matching the performance of its higher-priced counterparts, these speeds are still commendable and reflect HP's value-for-money proposition. While the Dell XPS 17 and Samsung

Galaxy Book3 Ultra have faster SSDs on paper, the practical, real-world difference for most users compared to the HP Pavilion Plus 16 might not be substantial, especially for general use. The difference is more evident in specialised scenarios that involve heavy file transfers or specific high-end applications.

VERDICT

The HP Pavilion Plus 16, equipped with the RTX 3050 GPU, demonstrates a notable performance gap compared to the pricier Galaxy Book3 Ultra and Dell XPS 17, which feature the more powerful RTX 4070 GPU. Despite its lower performance, the HP Pavilion Plus 16 offers good value for money, targeting users with modest gaming and multimedia needs. The HP Pavilion Plus 16 strikes a remarkable balance between stylish design, practical functionality, and affordability. The laptop's dimensions and weight make it notably portable for a 16-inch model, ideal for users seeking a spacious screen without sacrificing ease of transportation. Moreover, its use of sustainable materials like recycled aluminium speaks to its environmentally friendly design ethos.

In conclusion, the HP Pavilion Plus 16 (2023) is an excellent choice for users who value a blend of style, functionality, and affordability. It's particularly appealing for those who need a large screen and good performance but are also mindful of budget constraints. While it may not compete with the likes of the Dell XPS 17 or Samsung Galaxy Book3 Ultra in terms of high-end performance, it stands out as a solid, value-for-money option in its own right.

—Yatnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: 13th Generation Intel Core™ i7 processor | Operating System: Windows 11 Home | Display: 40.6 cm (16 inches) diagonal WQXGA display | Graphics: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3050 | RAM: 16 GB LPDDR5 | Storage: 1 TB SSD | Ports: Thunderbolt 4 USB Type-C, USB Type-C 10Gbps, USB Type-A 10Gbps, USB Type-A 5Gbps, AC smart pin, HDMI-out 2.1, and a headphone/microphone combo

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